

Philipp Hilbert. *On-chain PM who ships from protocol to consumer.*

Positioning, ten years shipping regulated financial products, now building crypto-native infrastructure from DEX aggregation to DeFi yield, purpose-built for Kraken's hybridisation layer.

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§ WHY KRAKEN

Kraken's hybridisation effort is precisely the problem worth solving: closing the gap between on-chain protocols and the consumer experience that makes them usable at scale. The job description names cross-functional alignment across Pro and Consumer as the central tension, that is exactly the kind of competing-priority environment I have spent a decade navigating, most recently across multinational aerospace and public-sector programmes where no single team owned the full chain. What draws me to Kraken specifically is that the technical substrate is real: bridges, AMMs, perpetuals, and settlement infra, not a tokenisation press release. *That is the environment where deep protocol fluency and consumer product sense compound into something rare.*

§ HONEST FRAMING

I have not held a PM title inside a crypto exchange or DeFi protocol team, and I want to name that plainly. What I do bring is eight years of active participation across CEX and DEX venues, Hyperliquid, Jupiter, 1inch, Across Protocol, combined with the payment flow, regulated-platform, and consumer-UX depth that comes from shipping fintech products from zero to acquisition. The transferable mechanic is identical: a complex technical layer that must disappear behind a simple, trustworthy user experience.

§ AI-NATIVE STACK

Daily tools, not buzzwords.

- **Claude Code**, in-repo spec and edge-case generation
- **GitHub Copilot**, assisted development and review
- **Cursor / VSCode**, agentic refactors and prototyping
- **Lovable**, rapid front-end prototyping
- **n8n**, multi-agent and agentic workflow automation
- **Framer**, design-heavy wireframes and demos
- **Gamma.app**, stakeholder decks and discovery artefacts
- **GPT**, research synthesis and prompt-driven discovery

§ TECHNICAL ENVIRONMENT

Shipped with, not just listed.

Kubernetes, OpenShift, ArgoCD, Helm, Docker, GitOps, Jenkins, CI/CD, GitLab, Azure DevOps, Python, Kotlin (Spring Boot), Django, PostgreSQL, MongoDB, Kafka, REST APIs, Dagster, dbt, ETL pipeline design, Jira, Confluence, Figma, Miro.

§ SIDE PROJECT

LIBERATION OF [BAJOR GITHUB.COM/HILBERTP](https://github.com/HilbertP) →

A self-built multi-agent coding framework, grown out of daily crypto infrastructure work.

- Orchestrates file-queue-based agent loops for autonomous feature delivery end-to-end.
- Architecture: lightweight Python process manager routing tasks across LLM-backed workers with human-in-the-loop checkpoints.
- Companion project phoenix882.com: trading-strategy backtesting engine consuming CEX and DEX market data.
- Directly relevant to Kraken's onchain tooling layer: demonstrates comfort designing the agentic systems that sit behind consumer-facing crypto experiences.

§ HOW I WOULD WORK AT KRAKEN

First weeks, concrete.

WEEK 1

Listen, map, find the gaps.

Shadow the Pro and Consumer squads, map the current hybridisation surface against the onchain roadmap, and identify where cross-functional alignment is missing or contested.

WEEK 2

Slice and prioritise.

Run structured discovery sessions with Engineering, Growth, and Legal to score the roadmap backlog against value, feasibility, and compliance risk, and surface the first high-confidence slice.

WEEK 3+

Ship and close loops.

Drive the first incremental release through launch, instrument the key metrics, and establish the iteration cadence that keeps Pro and Consumer moving in the same direction.

I COVER LETTER

Kraken's hybridisation effort is one of the most technically honest problems in consumer crypto right now. Most platforms either bolt a DeFi widget onto a CeFi shell and call it hybrid, or they expose raw protocol complexity and lose everyone below the power-user line. The job description signals that Kraken is trying to do neither: it asks for someone who can shape a genuine onchain roadmap and simultaneously make those experiences simple, intuitive, and accessible. That combination is rare, and it is the one I have been building toward.

My crypto engagement is hands-on and infrastructure-oriented. I actively trade and manage assets across Hyperliquid, Bitget, Jupiter, 1inch and Across Protocol, which means I work daily with perpetual futures, DEX aggregation, cross-chain bridging, and real wallet management. Beyond usage, I study market microstructure: liquidation heatmaps, execution quality, slippage, price impact, and routing logic via Coinglass and Hyblock Capital. I have built my own trading-strategy backtesting engine (phoenix882.com) and a multi-agent coding framework (Liberation of Bajor) that automates end-to-end feature delivery. I am not interested in the token price; I am interested in the systems, incentives, and operational mechanics that make digital asset markets function at scale.

On the product side, I bring a specific track record in exactly the cross-functional complexity Kraken is navigating. At Rohde & Schwarz, I led a multinational AI platform team through competing architectural visions, introduced GitOps delivery that cut rollout time from days to thirty minutes, and redirected the product when instrumented user data showed the beautiful UI was recording zero clicks. At EMIL Group, I restructured an eighteen-person organisation

that was losing its senior engineers, cut attrition from near-total to a single departure, and shipped the Claims Center from concept to production with no prior precedent. At Kvitt Payment Solutions, I built a mobile P2P fintech from zero to acquisition by Sparkasse inside the girocard ecosystem. The pattern across all three: complex technical layer, consumer-facing simplicity, and real organisational weight to carry through delivery.

What I do not have is a PM title inside an exchange or protocol team, and I prefer to name that directly rather than obscure it. I compensate with eight years of daily, infrastructure-level crypto engagement and with a career of regulated financial product ownership, payments, insurance, public-sector data, secure encryption, where the stakes of getting the user experience wrong were equally high. The stakeholder management, the roadmap advocacy, the external partner negotiation, the consumer-first product sense: those are transferable, and in my experience they are rarer on a PM résumé than technical fluency.

The onchain economy needs a bridge layer that consumers can trust. Kraken has the brand, the infrastructure, and now the team ambition to build it. I would like to be part of that effort.

Best regards, *Philipp Hilbert*

II CURRICULUM VITAE

§ BEARING

Product manager and owner with thirteen years of end-to-end delivery in regulated industries, fintech, insurance, defence AI, public-sector analytics, and healthtech, with eight years of parallel, infrastructure-level engagement in crypto and DeFi. I run continuous discovery, translate strategy and user needs into a prioritised roadmap, and lead cross-functional teams through agile delivery at scale. My focus for this role is the hybridisation layer: making onchain experiences trustworthy and simple for consumer and professional audiences without hiding the underlying protocol depth from those who need it.

§ WHAT I CAN DO

Web3 and DeFi: CEX and DEX mechanics, AMMs, perpetuals, bridging, DEX aggregation, liquidation analysis, cross-chain asset management, market microstructure.

Fintech and Payments: P2P payment flow design, PSP integration, consumer payment UX, regulated product launch, girocard ecosystem.

Product Ownership: requirements engineering, user stories, acceptance criteria, backlog refinement, sprint planning, velocity and burndown, release planning, UAT, Jira, Confluence, Figma, Miro.

Product Management: continuous discovery, product vision, roadmap ownership, prioritisation, MVP definition, A/B testing, user research, prototyping, go-to-market support.

Agile and Scaled Delivery: Scrum, Kanban, SAFe, ART, PI planning.

Stakeholder and Leadership: stakeholder alignment, cross-functional team leadership, C-level reporting, workshop facilitation, conflict resolution, external partner negotiation.

AI Products and Tooling: LLM agents, agentic workflows, prompt and context engineering, evaluation loops, human-in-the-loop design, AI governance, EU AI Act, Explainable AI; prototyping with Claude Code, GitHub Copilot, Cursor, Lovable.

Analytics and Data: funnel and churn analysis, KPI definition, ETL, Dagster, dbt, PostgreSQL, Matomo, MicroStrategy.

Technical Environments: Kubernetes, OpenShift, ArgoCD, Docker, GitOps, Jenkins, CI/CD, GitLab, Azure DevOps, Python, Kotlin (Spring Boot), Django, PostgreSQL, MongoDB, Kafka, REST APIs.

Governance: GDPR, Deputy IT Security Officer, identity management, budget and financial planning as CFO.

§ PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

ROHDE & SCHWARZ · PRODUCT MANAGER · DEFENCE AI 2024 TO 2025

Internal AI and data platform for the FCAS European programme. Introduced GitOps with ArgoCD across a multinational team; rollout time fell from days to 30 minutes and the platform became hotfix-capable. Redirected product from UI-first to developer-code-first design after instrumented user data showed zero engagement with the original.

BUNDESAGENTUR FÜR ARBEIT · PRODUCT MANAGER · PUBLIC SECTOR ANALYTICS 2023 TO 2024

National labour-market analytics platform. Integrated test automation into CI pipeline, introduced Dagster and dbt for quarterly imports, migrated bare-metal to containers, and carried a full UI relaunch. Deputy IT Security Officer.

CLINET PLATFORMS · PRODUCT OWNER · HEALTHCARE 2023

Mobile patient app. Cut roadmap to the top 10% of features; user acceptance rose fivefold. Implemented CGM interface into hospital information system: digital anamnesis time fell from 30 minutes to 5.

EMIL GROUP · PRODUCT MANAGER · INSURANCE B2B SAAS 2022

Restructured 18-person delivery organisation into three lean teams; attrition fell from near-total to a single departure. Shipped the Claims Center from concept to production with no precedent, cutting time-to-market for a new insurance product from months to under a week.

SCHEIDT & BACHMANN · PRODUCT OWNER INTEGRATION · RETAIL AND PAYMENTS 2021 TO 2022

POS and forecourt systems. Moved research results into production across a matrix organisation in a fully SAFe setup with agile release trains and PI planning.

BUNDESDRUCKEREI · INTERIM PRODUCT OWNER · GOVERNMENT 2021

Secure data platform. Data structures and identity management for Robert Koch Institute programmes DIM and DESH.

AOK ITSCARE · PROXY PRODUCT OWNER · HEALTH INSURANCE 2019 TO 2020

B2B procurement webshop. Migrated legacy system to Shopware for three AOK insurers and roughly 20,000 employees; still in production.

ENERCON · PROJECT LEAD · WIND ENERGY 2019

Full site IT modernisation end to end.

WALDBURG-ZEIL KLINIKEN · PRODUCT OWNER · HEALTHCARE 2017 TO 2018

Clinical network. WLAN rollout across nine hospitals.

§ FOUNDER AND EARLY-STAGE EXPERIENCE

CONSTRUCT8 · FOUNDER AND PM · CONSTRUCTION STAFFING 2025 TO 2026

Two-sided B2B marketplace, zero to one alone. Anonymity-until-payment model; WhatsApp and Telegram as product surface; LLM agents across the funnel so one person runs the day-to-day.

QCRYPT AG · CO-FOUNDER AND PRODUCT OWNER · IT SECURITY 2016 TO 2021

Quantum-secure encryption hardware and software. Shipped a three-layer product that installs in under two minutes for enterprise buyers; later Chair of the Board.

KVITT PAYMENT SOLUTIONS · FOUNDER AND CFO · FINTECH 2013 TO 2018

Mobile group-based P2P payments, built from zero and taken to acquisition by Sparkasse inside the girocard ecosystem.

SMART SOIL TECHNOLOGIES · CO-FOUNDER CDO AND CFO · NANOTECHNOLOGY 2018 TO 2021

Fertiliser product from laboratory to investor rounds; owned financial planning and investor reporting.

§ LANGUAGES

German, native. English, C2.

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TRUE NORTH · APPLICATION PACKAGE · KRAKEN

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